

DevOps and Agile: A Successful Project Needs Both



Both the DevOps and Agile approaches are good for software development.

Though both focus on different aspects of software development, each complements the other to produce robust, reliable, efficient and quality software in the shortest possible timeframe. This article goes into the differences between DevOps and Agile, and how beneficial it is when both work in tandem.

Development teams have been adopting Agile for the past ten years, as it has proved to be a very competent method of developing quality software. The Agile model has improved the user experience by frequently addressing focused goals and ensuring quick delivery. In addition, the broad use of DevOps in Agile methodology has made it a more compelling approach for IT organisations.

While many organisations are keen to employ these practices, there is often some uncertainty about the two. Some think that Agile is like Scrum and DevOps is a continuous delivery tool. But remember, Agile is not DevOps, and vice versa. It is hard to achieve success in DevOps, if Agile practices are not followed. And while Agile can make sense independent of DevOps, it can be more complete when accompanied by DevOps practices. Agile and DevOps are two software development methodologies with similar aims, i.e., getting the end product out as quickly and as efficiently as possible.

What is DevOps?

DevOps is the process of incorporating a particular culture and set of practices to achieve faster delivery, quicker automation, more agility, improved security and be able to serve better. It makes for a smooth flow between the IT operations team and the development team to deploy code quicker, automate tests and deliver results, which is a continuous process.

What is Agile?

The Agile methodology is a software development methodology that came to light in 2001, when the Agile manifesto was introduced. Agile encourages acceptance and a leadership mindset that promotes teamwork, self-

organisation, and accountability. More essentially, the Agile approach focuses more on continuously aligning development with customer requirements and trends — even when those requirements and trends change late in the development process.

Agile vs DevOps

DevOps	Agile
A technical practice to achieve an end solution	It is more about processes like the Scrum methodology and Sprint
DevOps is an improvement on the Agile process	Agile is all about rapid and frequent deployment
Operation as deployment is just a small part of ops -- the others being configuration management, etc.	It is the link between design thinking and DevOps
Aligns ops with stability, such as scripting deployment and standardising app build	Aligns development with business priorities, thus focusing on speeding up the development process
DevOps helps to bridge the line between several cross-functional teams	In Agile, the gaps between these teams are bridged daily by Scrum calls
Aims at faster deliveries through automation via various applications and tools like Docker, Chef, etc	Aims at streamlined delivery via tools like Kanban Board, Scrum, extreme programming, etc
DevOps is about continuous software deployment and its related activities	Agile is the process of software development